

Believe it or not, the store isn't the only place you can get cosmetics; you can also make them yourself! There are hundreds of DIY recipes that use everyday ingredients and are completely free of harmful toxins.

All you have to do is stock up on sterilized empty jars with tight fitting lids (you can find clear ones on [Amazon.com](https://www.amazon.com)), then browse Pinterest to find replacement recipes for your favorite finds.

In one five-minute search I printed off recipes for makeup remover, mineral makeup, eyeliner, concealer, and even natural lipstick. Best of all, they cost pennies compared to more expensive brands.

A word of caution, though—because homemade makeup products don't contain any preservatives, you'll need to keep some of them in the fridge so bacteria won't have a chance to grow. They also need to be replaced more often.

5. GRAB FREE SAMPLES

One of my favorite ways to try new makeup is through free samples. Even though most stores have those generous return policies we talked about before, I hate spending money in the first place for something I'm not even sure I'll use.

[MoneySavingMom.com](https://www.moneysavingmom.com) or [Freebies4Mom.com](https://www.freebies4mom.com) are sites to keep an eye on, and sign up when beauty freebies are available. Sephora, Smashbox, and Ulta also allow you to add samples to your online cart before checking out. And don't forget to check with your Mary Kay consultant too.

Even though these are mostly for one-time application purposes, I can usually squeeze at least two to three uses out of them, which means I can go longer in between makeup purchases!

READER TIP:

I love using ELF products. You can find them at Target or online for only \$1-\$3, and some of them are REALLY great. I love their tweezers, eye shadow, lip glosses, tinted moisturizers, so many things! I also